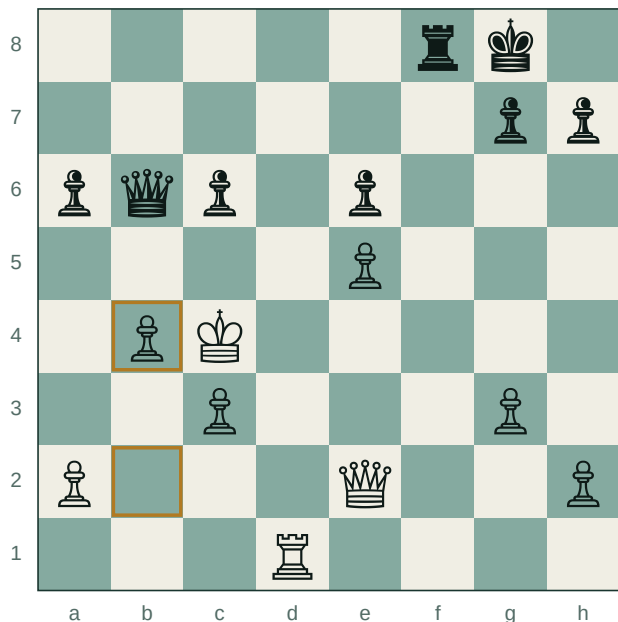


# Skewers: Black, move 28

Skewers

Black to move



Previous move: 28.b4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**28...Qb5+ 29. Kb3 Qxe2**

**28...Qb5+** Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **29.Kb3**.

**29...Qxe2** The queen captures the queen on e2.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from -1 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on c4. Geometrically undefended: queen on e2. Check for tactical protection.